



The Just Shall Live by Faith “Paul’s Hall of Fame” Romans 16:1-27

The hallmark of an effective church is its ability to maintain unity in the midst of diversity and adversity.

- The marks of diversity in the church at Rome included their:
 - **Different Status**—they were from all levels of society.
 - **Different Race**—they were from all cultural backgrounds.
- the marks of unity in the church at Rome included:
 - **“In Christ,”** used four times.
 - **“In the Lord,”** used five times.
 - **“Fellow worker,” “Fellow sufferer,”** and **“Beloved,”** used several times.
 - Beloved means: “Loved with Agape love.”

- What drew them together as a church family was what they believed about Jesus, and that is called doctrine.
- What a Christian believes about the doctrines of God, Christ, the Holy Spirit, the Church, and the Bible, is called theology.
- Jude referred to it as “the faith,” that body of truth that was once and for all delivered to the saints.
- In the book of Romans alone, Paul explained:
 - **God’s plan for man’s redemption**—i.e., salvation by grace alone, through man’s faith alone, and in Christ alone, plus nothing!
 - **God’s purpose for the Church**—how it is to operate, the gifts of the Holy Spirit that have been given to every believer to carry out those functions.
 - **God’s call upon every believer**—to see that the gospel of Jesus Christ is proclaimed in every area of the world.
- In Romans 16, the Apostle Paul showed us how to build up the Body of Christ by being united in our faith in Christ.
 - **Receive those who are greatly used of God**—as illustrated in the life and ministry of Phebe—vs 1-2.
 - **Great those who show hospitality**—as illustrated in the ministry of Priscilla and Aquilla—vs 3-4.
 - **Salute those who are new converts**—as illustrated by Epenetus—vs 5.
 - **Greet those whose labor greatly assists those in leadership**—as illustrated by Mary, Urbane, Tryphena, Tryphosa, and Persis—vs 6, 9, 12.
 - **Salute those who are willing to suffer for the sake of the gospel**—as illustrated by Andronicus and Junia and Apelles—vs 7, 10.
 - **Recognize those who are beloved in the Lord**—as illustrated by Amplias, Stachys, Persis, Rufus and his mother—vs 8, 9, 12, 13.
 - **Welcome those who are not in the same social status as others**—as illustrated by the household of Aristobulus, and the household of Narcissus—vs 10, 11.
 - **Receive those who are faithful in their attendance**—as illustrated in the unknown servants—vs 14-16.
 - **Greet those who are relatives of those who are serving the Lord**—as illustrated by Herodion—vs 11.
 - **Greet on another with a holy kiss**—which is a kiss on both cheeks.
 - **Note those who cause divisions and avoid them**—vs 17.
- **The word doctrine (didaskalia) is translated as the “act of teaching”**—1 Timothy 4:6-8.
 - **Genesis to Malachi**—Christ was concealed yet there is the promise of a Messiah to come Who will provide salvation for lost man.
 - **Matthew to Revelation**—Christ is revealed as the Savior sent from God to save us from our sins.
 - **Should anyone enter the church with any other doctrine, they should be “accursed”**—to be banished from the fellowship and cast into the hands of Satan for destruction.

- **Value what is good**—(that which has been helpful to you in building your faith)

Paul said:

- Because you have been obedient to what you have been taught up to now.
- Because you have continued to be wise unto that which is good—yet sensitive to that which is evil.
- God is going to give you victory over Satan very soon.

**“IF THE TRUTH BE FORSAKEN FOR ANY REASON, THE UNITY AND
PURITY OF THE CHURCH FELLOWSHIP WILL NOT LAST!”**

**According to 2 Timothy 4:1-5,
the most desperate need
in the church today is
sound doctrine!**